This spin on a popular Indian curry makes an innovative first course. The crackling curry leaves, toasted spices, and tangy tamarind work well with the yogurt base.

whipped yogurt soup with sautéed zucchini

SERVES 4 **PREP** 30 MINS, PLUS 20 MINS STANDING **COOK** 25 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

3 tbsp vegetable oil
2 dried red chiles
1 tsp mustard seeds
¼ tsp fenugreek seeds
1 tsp cumin seeds
12 curry leaves
3 tbsp gram flour
½ tsp turmeric
1¾ cups Greek yogurt
1¾ cups cold water
2 tbsp tamarind pulp
2 tbsp chopped cilantro, to garnish

for the sautéed zucchini topping
2 tbsp vegetable oil
1 small red onion, diced
1 zucchini, finely diced
1 green chile, seeded and finely chopped
sea salt flakes, to season

1 Heat the oil in a wok over medium heat. Toss in the chiles and mustard seeds and swirl around for a few seconds before adding the fenugreek, cumin, and curry leaves. Lower the heat and stir-fry for a few seconds. Sprinkle in half the flour and stir-fry for 2–3 minutes or until lightly toasted. Remove from the heat, add the turmeric, and let cool slightly.

2 Whisk the remaining flour with the yogurt and water and add to the wok. Return to the heat and, whisking all the time, bring to a simmer and cook for 3–4 minutes. Add more water, if needed, to loosen the consistency. I like to leave the whole spices in, but you can sieve the soup at this stage. Season with salt and enough tamarind to sharpen.

3 For the sautéed zucchini topping, heat the oil in a frying pan and soften the onion for 3–4 minutes over low heat. Turn the heat up, add the zucchini and green chile, and continue cooking for another minute. Season with salt and add to the hot soup. Finish with the chopped cilantro.